The Road to Emmaus

Luke 24:13–35

The big idea: Two disciples had every fact about Jesus and still walked home in despair. Then the risen Jesus opened the Scriptures to them, and they saw that the whole Bible had been pointing to him.

Before you meet: Read

Luke 24:13–35

Open (5 minutes)

Have you ever tried to read the Bible on your own? Where did you get stuck, or what confused you?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

The two disciples were walking from Jerusalem to a village called _____, about seven miles away. *(Luke 24:13)*

"But we had _____ that he was the one to redeem Israel." *(Luke 24:21)*

"And beginning with _____ and all the Prophets, he interpreted to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning _____." *(Luke 24:27)*

Discuss

1. Cleopas had all the facts about Jesus and still walked away sad. Why didn't the facts help him? *Luke 24:19–24*

2. "We had hoped." When have you been disappointed with God because he did not do what you expected? *Luke 24:21*

3. Jesus said the whole Old Testament is about him. What difference does that make in how you read Genesis or Leviticus? *Luke 24:27, 44*

4. Their hearts burned while Jesus opened the Scriptures. What would it look like to come to this study expecting to meet him, and not only to learn about him? *Luke 24:32*

Memory verse

> *"Did not our hearts burn within us while he talked to us on the road, while he opened to us the Scriptures?"*
>
> **Luke 24:32**

Pray

Thank God that the Bible is his own word and that it is about his Son. Ask him to open your eyes as you read this year, the way Jesus opened the Scriptures on the road.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 1

The Road to Emmaus

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Luke 24:13–35 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 1–2 and Revelation 21–22).

Main points to land

1. The Bible is a library of sixty-six books that tells one story, and Jesus is its center (Luke 24:27, 44).
2. Knowing facts about Jesus is not the same as knowing him. Cleopas had the facts and missed the story.
3. The Bible is God's own word, the only rule for what we believe and how we live (2 Timothy 3:16; WSC 2–3). We come to it expecting to meet Christ (Luke 24:32).

Core doctrine to teach

The Authority of Scripture CORE DOCTRINE 1 OF 26 · SCRIPTURE ALONE

The Bible is God's own word, written by human authors as the Holy Spirit carried them along. It is true in all it teaches, and it is the final authority over everything we believe and do. Traditions, feelings, and experts are tested by Scripture, never the other way around. *2 Timothy 3:16–17; 2 Peter 1:20–21; Luke 24:27, 44*

Answer key (Observe)

1. Emmaus
2. hoped
3. Moses; himself

Questions people will ask

Is the Old Testament really about Jesus, or are Christians reading him into it?
Jesus himself said it was about him (Luke 24:27, 44; John 5:39). Christians do not find Jesus in every verse the same way, but the whole Old Testament story, its promises, sacrifices, kings, and prophets, points forward to him. Augustine put it this way: the New is hidden in the Old, and the Old is made plain in the New.

Closing prayer

Lord Jesus, you walked with two discouraged disciples and opened the Scriptures to them. Walk with us this year. Open your word to us, make our hearts burn as we read, and show us yourself on every page. Amen.